

1. This Book of vision shows us (who we are in Christ) what we are worth in redemption (what we can do) and how to do them in order to fulfil God's plan and purpose for our lives (Joshua 1:8; Deuteronomy 28:1).

2. Here are three illustrations that help us to see the Bible as the custodian of God's plan for our lives: **"Original Information"**

The Bible is the Creator's Manual for Living: We understand from scriptures that we are God's products and the Bible is His manual that empowers us to discover and pursue His plan and purpose for our lives. God specifically made us in His image and after His likeness. Therefore, we are His people and the sheep of His pastures (Joshua 1:8; Jeremiah 29:11; Isaiah 2:1; Isaiah 14:24; Psalm 100:3).

The Bible is the **Spiritual Water** that shows us what we look like: We understand from scriptures that the Word of God is likened to water that reflects our nature in Christ. Just as our reflections appear when we look into a bowl of water, our true identity in Christ is also revealed to us when we study God's Word. This was graphically illustrated by a story told by Kenneth E. Hagin of a lion cub that was captured and made to grow among sheep. It lost its identity by virtue of the environment it found itself, until the day it saw its reflection on the surface of the water. That day, it regained its identity and confidence, and stood its ground when the other sheep fled from the appearance of a lion. This illustration helps us to understand that when we look into (Study) God's Word and believe what He says about us, He confers us with dominion over every torment of wickedness (Ephesians 5:26; Proverbs 27:19).

3. The Bible is the **Spiritual mirror** that reveals (shows) the actual worth of the Redeemed: When we behold God's picture for our lives from the mirror of the Word and take responsibility as contained therein, that picture becomes a reality in us (James 1:22-25; 2 Corinthians 3:18). However, we must recognize that the Bible is sealed to everyone that is not redeemed. Until we are born again, we cannot access the 'sealed' plan of God from the Bible. This is because **only the redeemed** has access to the mysteries of the Kingdom of God (Mark 4:11; John 1:12).

Let's examine a few pictures of who we are from scriptures:

2 CORINTHIANS 3:18:
All of us, as with unveiled faces, [Brethren] we continually behold [in the word of God] as in a mirror the glory of the Lord, and constantly being transformed into His very image in ever increasing splendour and glory.

AND HE SAID UNTO THEM UNTO YOU IT IS GIVEN TO KNOW THE MYSTERY OF THE KINGDOM OF GOD: BUT HE SAID UNTO THEM THAT ARE WITHOUT, ALL THESE THINGS ARE DONE IN PARABLES OR WILL BE ARE.

GET TO THE WATER

From scriptures, we discover that every child of God is redeemed a **Spiritual Lion**.

Before his fall in the Garden of Eden, man was the king of all creation. But after the fall, he was dethroned and became a victim of the wickedness of the devil. Until Jesus Christ, the Lion of the Tribe of Judah came to restore man to his dominion and Christ-like status. As a result, every child of God is redeemed a spiritual lion, and ordained for dominion over every situation and circumstance (Revelations 5:5; John 17:18; Hebrews 2:11).

Furthermore, just as the natural lion was created for dominion in the animal kingdom, so is every child of God created for dominion in the world of the spirit (Proverbs 30:29-30; Genesis 49:8-12).

But, what does it take to manifest our Lion Nature?

Firstly, we must understand that the dominion of a lion is a function of its strength, and its strength is a function of the quality of meat that it feeds on. 'Meat' here connotes principles from the Word of God (Jeremiah 15:16).

There are four levels of nutrition in the Word of God:

- The water level of the Word (Isaiah 55:1, 10-11).
- The milk level of the Word (1 Peter 2:2).
- The meat level of the Word (Hebrew 13:9).
- The strong meat level of the Word: "Strong meat" here implies scriptural mysteries that confer mastery (dominion) on the redeemed (Hebrew 5:13-14; Psalm 45:3-5; 1 Corinthians 2:9).

Therefore, to keep the lion in us alive, we must do the following:

- Feed on strong meat:** Just as the natural lion feeds on the wild beasts to sustain its vigour, vitality and dominion, we must also feed on the strong meat of the Word (mysteries) in order to dominate every challenge that may confront us (Hebrew 5:14).
- Feed on Fresh Meat:** Lions thrive on fresh kills; they don't feed on yesterday's meal. Similarly, the fresher the revelation we encounter, the more alive the lion in us becomes and the more dominion we would command (Luke 11:3; John 5:30; John 8:28-29).
- Feed on the Meat in Season:** The meat in season here refers to the timely Word from God that deals with the issue at hand. However, we must understand that every lion either hunts for its food or dies of hunger. That simply means, if we are not Word hunters, the lion in us would be weak and helpless (Isaiah 50:4; Matthew 8:28-32; Matthew 13:54).

JOHN 8:28-29 - 2 FRESH MEAT
... WHEN YE HAVE LIFTED UP THE SON OF MAN, THEN SHALL YE KNOW THAT I AM HE, AND THAT I DO NOTHING OF MY OWN ACCORD.

JOHN 8:30 - FRESH MEAT
I CAN OF MY OWN SELF DO NOTHING: AS I HEAR, I TALK: AND MY VOICE SHALL NOT BE HEARD BECAUSE I SEE NOT THE FATHER.